



The Empire was filthy rich

Death Star from the Star Wars universe costs \$15.6 septillion - 1.4 trillion times the US debt <http://gizmo.do/Yk7n>



M\$ making \$\$\$ via Android!

Microsoft is earning almost 5 times the income from Android devices than it is from WP7 - due to patent issues <http://bit.ly/oZRYQj>

Will Windows 8 trounce its predecessor?

Microsoft seems to have taken a page from Linux's book by releasing such an early version of the next Windows publicly. We take a look at what the Developer preview offers

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As good as Windows 7 is, it mostly just tried to repair some of the damage done by Windows Vista. Windows 8, in comparison, is very ambitious. Nearly every corner of the OS has been touched up, and it shows right from boot.

Windows 8 is highly inspired by its mobile cousin, Windows Phone 7, and uses the same UI style called Metro. Metro is a big and central part of Windows 8; it's hard to escape and it likely won't be something you can turn off even in the final release. It's not just about the UI, but also the work that has gone into creating a new way for developers to create Windows applications using even web technologies such as HTML5, CSS3 and JavaScript.

We immediately downloaded and tested Windows 8 on a desktop computer so our experience is mostly based on how it works in a non-touch environment. However, some of the new major additions to Windows 8 actually have to do with tablets. Windows 8 is essentially meant to be an OS that can run on tablets, netbooks and desktops, with Windows Phone catering to smartphones.

Let's first dispense with the rumours that Windows 8 will only have the toned down Metro UI, with the familiar Windows desktop done away with. This isn't true. The familiar old Windows 7 UI and



Windows 8 Metro start screen



The Windows 8 lock screen



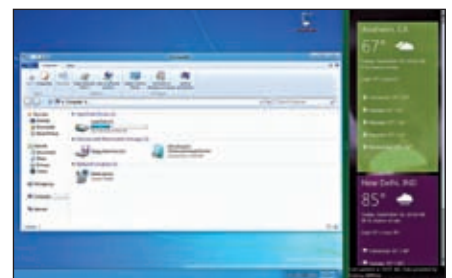
Searching for applications, results from settings, files and installed applications can also be browsed from here



The Metro version of Internet Explorer 10. Currently the desktop version looks the same as IE9



The new Metro-styled control panel



A Metro application is docked to the right of the screen while you work on a normal Windows application

desktop remains (mostly). So the question isn't what's lost in Windows 8, but whether what's added (Metro) is worthwhile or just gets in the way. That question, however, will be for you to answer once you've used it a bit. For that purpose, we'll divide our attention between the new Windows Metro UI and the "classic" UI.

Windows 8 'Metro' UI

Metro is a complete departure from the classic Windows UI and is optimised heavily for touch screens. Not only does

the OS need to be designed to work well with touch screens, but the applications do too. Since they are, after all, what people intend to use their device for. Windows 7 came with support for multi-touch screens, but no one made much of it because neither the Windows UI nor the UI of most Windows apps were very conducive to a good multi-touch experience. Windows 8 rectifies this with a fresh new tile-based Metro UI.

When you first boot Windows 8, you're greeted with this UI which shows